HSU, Ke-Cheng (Clio)

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Summary

PhD candidate in Economics at HKUST, graduating June 2027. Academic excellence: graduated first in class (CGA 3.9/4.3; Academic Achievement Medal, top 1%). Uses data to answer business questions and explains the results clearly to non-technical audiences. Leadership and communication experience as Hall Tutor and Teaching Assistant Coordinator, with student teaching ratings of 4.5–4.7 out of 5. Comfortable working across functions and through conflict. Hong Kong permanent resident; native Mandarin, fluent English, communicative Cantonese. Applying for the 2027 Management Trainee Programme, with Customer and Product Development as the preferred function.

Education

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Hong Kong

Doctor of Philosophy in Economics — Expected Graduation: June 2027

Master of Philosophy in Economics — 2020–2022 CGA: 4.1/4.3

Bachelor of Science in Mathematics and Economics, Minor in Actuarial Mathematics — 2015–2019 CGA: 3.9/4.3

Graduated first in class. Awards: Dean's List (2016–2019); University Scholarship (730K HKD); Academic Achievement Medal (top 1%); Postgraduate studentship (1.5M HKD); Redbird scholarship (40K HKD).

Experience

Teaching Assistant Coordinator, Department of Economics, HKUST — 2025–2026

- Evaluated teaching assistants' practice teaching, gave feedback on what to change, and helped them improve.

Hall Tutor, UG Hall I, HKUST — 2024–present

- Helped residents work through conflicts and supported student life in a residential community.

Lecturer & Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, HKUST — 2020–present

- Lecturer for MSc Math Camp (student rating 4.53/5); TA for PhD and undergraduate economics (average 4.72/5 across five courses).

Projects

Return Policy Design in E-Commerce *(Job Market Paper)*

- Studied how lenient an online apparel seller's return policy should be, using data from Taobao (2017–2023; six apparel categories; ∼62M RMB revenue; 20–30% return rates).
- Compared a lenient policy (seller pays return shipping) against a strict one (buyer pays), and proposed a third option: a menu letting buyers choose between a lower price with a partial restocking fee and a full price with a full refund.
- Found the menu beats both, reaching about 75% of the best attainable outcome in most categories; a back-of-envelope calculation suggests about 5 million RMB in profit improvement. The same method answers what a product team asks before a launch: how much a new product would sell, what it would contribute to profit, and whether it would cannibalize existing products.

Inventory and Pricing in the Japanese Book Market *(with K. Kawaguchi, HKUST; K. Kawai, U. Tokyo)*

- Studied how a publisher's pricing rule affects how many books bookstores order and discard, using data from over 1,000 Japanese bookstores (35–40% of printed books are discarded).
- Found that the standard approach overstates cost by about 20% because it ignores how stores adjust ordering to uncertain demand.
- Identified substitution patterns that matter for inventory and assortment decisions.

Skills

Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent), Cantonese (Communicative).
Technical: Python, R, C++, Stata, LaTeX, AWS, HPC/SLURM; structural estimation and counterfactual simulation.
AI: Uses AI tools for data management, coding, and generating weekly reports.
References: Kei Kawai (UTokyo; Compass Lexecon), Kohei Kawaguchi (HKUST; UTokyo Econ Consulting), Pak Hung Au (HKUST).